Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow

1. Problem Statement

In many educational institutions, library requests such as book issues, returns, and new book requests are handled manually or through disconnected systems. This leads to delays, mismanagement of requests, lack of tracking, and inefficiencies in communication between students and library staff. Manual processes also increase the chances of errors and make it difficult to maintain proper records. Therefore, there is a need for an automated workflow system that can efficiently manage library requests, ensure transparency, and improve overall user experience.

2. Objective

The main objective of this project is to design and implement a Smart Library Request Workflow using ServiceNow. The system aims to automate library-related requests such as book issue, return, and new book requests. It helps in reducing manual effort, improving request tracking, and ensuring timely approvals. Additionally, the workflow enhances efficiency by providing real-time updates, notifications, and structured data management for better decision-making.

3. Skills Required

- Basic understanding of ServiceNow platform
- Knowledge of workflow and flow designer
- Familiarity with database concepts
- Understanding of forms, tables, and fields
- Basic scripting knowledge (optional)
- Problem-solving and logical thinking

4. Task Initiation

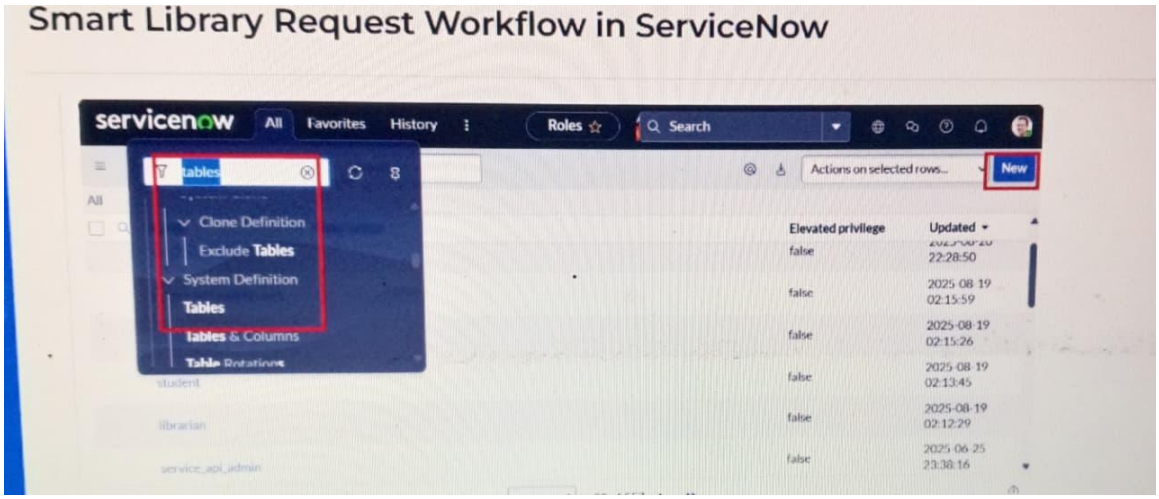
Step 1: Requirement Analysis

- Identify types of requests (Book Issue, Return, New Book Request)

- Define approval flow (Student → Librarian → Approval/Rejection)

- Identify required fields (Book Name, Author, Request Type, Student Name, Status)

Step 2: Create Library Request Table



- Open ServiceNow

- Go to All → System Definition → Tables

- Click on New

- Table Name: Library Request

- Add fields: Student Name, Book Name, Author, Request Type, Status, Request Date

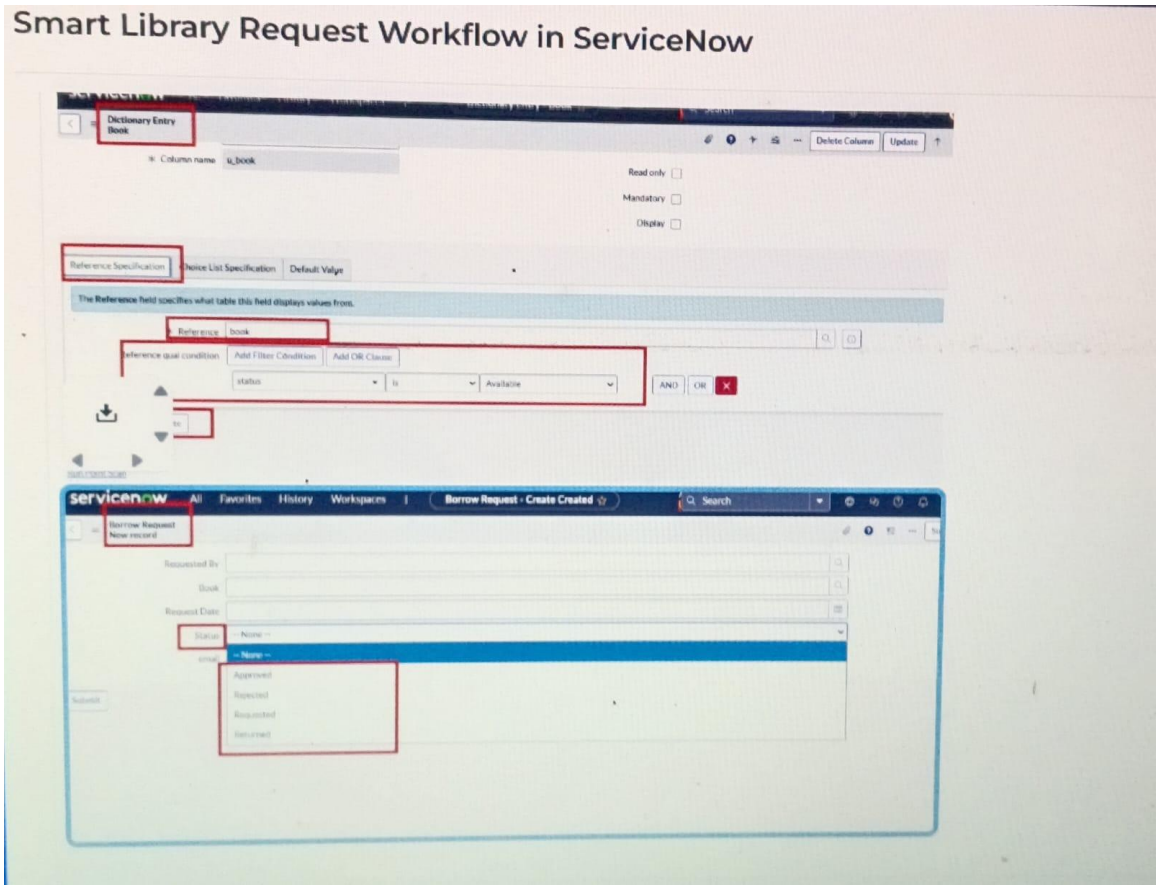
Step 3: Create Application Form

- Navigate to Service Catalog → Maintain Items

- Create new item: Library Request Form

- Add variables: Student Name, Book Name, Author, Request Type

Step 4: Design Workflow using Flow Designer



- Go to Flow Designer

- Create new flow: Library Request Workflow

- Set trigger: When record is created

Step 5: Add Approval Action

- Add approval step

- Set approver as Librarian

Step 6: Add Actions Based on Approval

- If approved → Update status to Approved

- If rejected → Update status to Rejected

Step 7: Automate Notifications

- Create notifications for submission, approval, and rejection

Step 8: Create Service Portal View

- Display request status and submitted requests

Step 9: Test the Workflow

- Submit request

- Verify approval process

- Check notifications

Additional Feature: SLA

Description

The Library Management Project successfully optimized the process of borrowing and managing books within ServiceNow by implementing structured workflows, role-based access control, and automated approvals. Students can submit borrow requests seamlessly, while librarians can review, validate, and process requests efficiently through controlled access and defined responsibilities.

The system enhances transparency by incorporating request status tracking, automated notifications, and reporting capabilities, ensuring that all stakeholders remain informed throughout the process. Proper validations reduce errors, prevent unauthorized actions, and maintain accurate record management.

Overall, the solution improves operational efficiency, strengthens accountability, and provides a scalable framework that can be extended to support additional academic services such as digital resources, reservation systems, or asset tracking in the future.

- Create SLA with duration of 2 days for request handling

Conclusion

This project automates the library request system using ServiceNow. It improves efficiency, reduces manual work, and ensures proper tracking of requests. The workflow enhances user experience and makes the system reliable and structured.